entertained, of the dreadful consequences likely to result from their mixture with those who may have had a sober education, and have entered voluntarily into the service of their country; and likewise of the danger to society in general, from turning loose such a set of wretches at the close of a war.

Our English prisons have also contributed their share towards recruiting the army, enlisting being the condition on which many have obtained their release from confinement, or immunity from some other punishment. I shall make no further remark on this practice, but that if it be a necessary one, the legislature may receive some satisfaction from the effects of their late salutary laws respecting the health of prisoners. If this mode had been adopted while prisons were in their former state, it would have been the occasion of carrying the most fatal diseases into the midst of our seamen and soldiers.

There is an Irish Act for preserving the health of prisoners, passed in the seventeenth and eighteenth of George III, chap. xxviii, similar to the English Act [1] for the same purpose. But I did not find it in any of the prisons. There is another Act of the same year, which is similar to the English Act, for "the punishment, by hard labour, of offenders who, for certain crimes, are or shall become liable to be transported." But the hulks on the Thames having cruelly destroyed many healthy and robust young men, their cries probably reached the Irish shore, and prevented any proceedings in consequence of that Act.

I carefully inspected the gaols in Dublin in 1783. The following remarks on the new prison I think particularly worth mentioning. It is not kept clean—The pumps being out of order there is no regular supply of water—There is no proper separation of the sexes from one another—or of petty offenders from the most abandoned criminals—Numbers of acquitted prisoners are detained for the fees—Such as are committed to hard labour are confined to idleness—There is no bedding, though the floors are stone—Spirituous liquors are sold in the

[1] This differs from the English Act in one important circumstance. The English Act requires "the walls and ceilings of the several cells and wards, both of the debtors and the felons, and also of any other rooms used by the prisoners in their respective gaols and prisons, where felons are usually confined, to be scraped and whitewashed, once in the year at least, to be regularly washed and kept clean, etc." whereas the Irish Act requires the same precautions in the cells, wards, and rooms of gaols and prisons without restriction; for the clause "where felons are usually confined" is omitted. I have known it pleaded as an excuse for not whitewashing and keeping clean the prisons in England where only debtors or petty offenders have been confined, that, they were not obliged to it by Act of Parliament.

prison—New-comers are robbed, or stripped and abused for the penny-pot or garnish—The proper prisoners have not the use of the day-rooms—The dungeons are used as lodging-rooms for prisoners before they are condemned—The sick have no proper rooms or beds, and no attention was paid to them[1]—No bath[2]—No divine service—The keeper does not reside in the prison—Criminals are made turnkeys—The Act for preserving the health of prisoners not hung up; nor any table of fees, rules or orders—The allowance, two-pennyworth of bread a day; but being delivered only twice a week, and not fixed by weight, some of the prisoners are almost starved.

To this gaol there are ample appointments. But such appointments can be of little consequence, while the sheriffs and magistrates neglect their duty, and seldom or never inspect the gaols or punish defaulters. Are not such magistrates inexcusably guilty? Should they not be considered as accessory to the crimes and abuses and miseries occasioned by their neglect?

Most of the remarks now made on this gaol at Dublin, are applicable to many of the county gaols.

I enumerate these particulars, not with a view of aggravating the idea of inattention to these objects in Ireland, or making a comparison between their management, and that in this country (which is still greatly defective); but with a view of inciting the public-spirited Irish gentlemen, now occupied on this subject, to set an example of a thorough and effectual reform, which may be imitated by this nation.

[1] Two of the committee of the House of Commons in June 1782 accompanied me to the new prison, and examined some of the sick who lay on the stone floors totally neglected. Dr. Cleghorn and Dr. Scott have been since ordered by the grand jury to attend them; but no bedding, no alteration of diet, and no nurses are ordered for them. I was sorry to find in 1783, that the former ingenious young physician had died of the gaol-fever.

[2] The only building designed for a bath which I saw in the gaols in Ireland, was in the courtyard at Trim, 17 June, 1782. I looked into it, and found it was the gaoler's pig-sty.